

bedded' with the product marketing team. They will attend all PMM meetings including 1:1s with team leaders.

Product Marketing will provide specific areas of focus (e.g. competitive intel) and projects (e.g. persona development, competitive benchmarking) at the beginning of the rotation.

We will not change official reporting structure (e.g. Workday) during the rotation

Participation in the rotation program does not change compensation structure

At the end of the rotation, there may be an opportunity to join the product marketing team should there be (1) available headcount and (2) ongoing consistent performance during the rotation.

Desired Outcomes for GitLab and the involved teams and individuals:

- To promote our values through internal mobility and contribute to long term career aspirations of the team members
- To cross functionally collaborate and drive outcomes for respective teams involved including but not limited to through evangelism - writing blogs, sharing experience, recording day in the lives videos

Eligibility/How to participate:

- The rotation program will only be available to teammates with strong performance, and who have been in their current role for at least 1 year.
- For the pilot program in Q2 FY25, SA and Product Marketing will be nominating a team member to participate and will establish learnings to iterate on the program for future quarters.
- All team members interested in future rotations should have completed an IGP with their manager, and indicate interest through their manager and to SA leadership.
- SA and Product Marketing leadership will review interested candidates, along with the SA team's ability to support the rotation due to workload requirements, in the month prior to the beginning of each quarter.
- Candidates will go through an interview process with the VP, Product Marketing to understand background, experience and interest areas in the rotation program.
- The experience will be tailored on a case by case basis matching 1. The needs for the business, and 2. The interest from the rotation candidate. For example:
- A set of deliverables associated with Competitive Intelligence. For example: Revamp competitive messaging/content against GitHub
- Re-cast the buyer persona documentation with full rollout across GTM.
- Conduct new hire Competitive Intel onboarding
- Maintain Crayon, our Competitive Intel platform.

Topics/Resources (sections with suggested resources/links)

Below are a list of resources and links to suggested professional development tools and resources:

Domain Specific Resources (SDLC/DevOps)

1. Agile (scrum,kanban, etc)

1. Videos and Webpages

- GitLab Agile Delivery
- Scrum.org- What is Scrum

- What is Kanban

1. Courses:

1. Conferences:

1. DevOps

1. Videos and Webpages

-GitLab DevOps

(Specifically the resources list at the bottom)

1. Courses:

1. Conferences:

1. Software Programming

Product Marketing specific resources

1. Product Marketing

1. Public Speaking

1. Storytelling

Marketing in general

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/pricing-tiers.md

Tiers

High Level Overview

- Deployment Options: Self Managed and SaaS

- Pricing Philosophy: We decide which feature goes into which tier based on the buyer.

| | Free | Premium | Ultimate |

| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |
----- |

| Likely Buyer | Individual Contributor | Manager or Director | Executive |

| Support | None | Priority support | Priority support |

| Version upgrade assistance | No | Yes | Yes |

| Dedicated Customer Success Manager | No | Yes | Yes |

| SDLC coverage | Basic | Complete coverage less Secure & Protect | Complete coverage |

| Version Control & Collaboration | Yes | Yes | Yes |

| Portfolio management capabilities | No | Yes | Yes |

| CI/CD | Better suited for single developers | Ideal for multiple teams | Ideal for large teams and/or multiple teams |

| External code repo support with GitLab CI/CD | No | Yes | Yes |

DevSecOps	No	No	Yes
End to end Insights and Analytics	No	Yes	Yes
Enterprise Readiness (High Availability, Disaster Recovery, Geo Replication support)	No		Yes
Enterprise Readiness (Compliance, Audit logs & Separation of Duties (SoD))	No	Yes	Yes
Compute minutes per group (SaaS only)	400	10,000	50,000
Storage Limits per project (SaaS only)	10GB	10GB	10GB

Tier Feature Composition

Below table shows new capabilities added per tier.

For further details on individual feature - visit [Why starter](#), [Why premium](#), [Why ultimate](#) pages.

	New in Premium	New in Ultimate
Version Control & Collaboration	Granular permission setting via multiple approvers, merge approvals, code owners	Optimize contribution via contributor analytics
Code Quality and visual reviews	Design Management	Web IDE and WYSIWYG Markdown Editor
Improve Developer Productivity via Productivity Analytics	Merge Request Reviews, Group and File Templates	
Agile Planning	Team Collaboration via Issue weights, multiple assignees, burndown charts and related issues	Streamline project planning with Roadmaps, Single Level Epics, Group backlog management, Group issue, assignee and milestone boards, issue analytics
Plan enterprise wide initiatives with multi level epics	Improve developer efficiencies with project insights	
CI/CD	Collaboration for small teams - Code Owners, Push rules, Merge Approvals	Deploy with confidence with Operations Dashboard, Pipeline dashboard, Merge trains, Multi Project Pipelines, Protected Environments and browser performance testing
DevSecOps	Shift security left with SAST, DAST, Dependency scanning, container scanning within your CI/CD pipeline itself	Visualize security status of each project with Security Dashboard
Enterprise Readiness	Authentication and Authorization via multiple LDAP, AD server support, Kerberos authentication	High Availability, Disaster Recovery and Geo Replication
Manage compliance with audit logs, auditor users, MR reviews	Ease of compliance with credentials management, license compliance and compliance dashboards	Free guest users to control your license consumption
Support	Enterprise level support with priority support, CSM and upgrade assistance	{Same as premium}

Customer License FAQs

The detailed customer license FAQ including questions around how to add users, how to upgrade / downgrade, is available [here](#)

Sales FAQs

- My customer is on GitLab Free. What tier should I upgrade them to?

A: If your customer is an enterprise customer OR is a company that is concerned about enterprise level features like compliance, HA/DR etc - you should upgrade them to at least the

Premium tier. See the top 10 reasons to NOT sell Starter/Bronze to your customer.

- My customer thinks that the price jump between tiers is too high. How do I counter this?

A: GitLab tiers add features/value progressively in the tiers. The key value of premium is its enterprise level support, enterprise readiness features and DevOps features required for growing and multiple teams. The key value of Ultimate is Security. If a customer chooses to purchase products from different vendors for the same usecases, the multiple / cost of ownership is significantly higher. See our ROI calculators and TEI reports for more justification.

- How does the true-up process work?

A: If a customer has added additional users during their subscription period, at renewal or annually (whichever comes first), the customer will need to provide the number of added users. These additional users will be billed for the entire year - irrespective of when the customer added the additional users.

- GitLab moved features down to a lower tier and now my customer would like to downgrade their Tier as they see enough value in the lower tier

A:

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/public-sector-gtm.md

Public Sector Message House

Booth Messaging / Tagline

- Secure the Speed to Mission.
Deliver more secure code faster and better.

Positioning Statement

For government agencies whose existing DevSecOps solution prevents their secure speed to mission. GitLab enables you to deliver secure software, automate the end-to-end DevSecOps experience, and empower collaboration between teams. We do this by embedding security (secure by design), automating software factory deployment, and increasing the speed of code deployment so that you can secure the speed to mission. This is underpinned by robust security scanning embedded within continuous integration (CI), automated requirements, and enterprise Agile planning where everyone can contribute.

Short Description

GitLab empowers government agencies to deliver secure software so they are successful with their digital transformation efforts to protect communities - securing the speed to mission.

Long Description

Government agencies strive to serve the public by providing optimal experiences to their communities. One way to do this is a successful digital transformation ensuring software is secure, manual processes are minimized, and there is collaboration between teams and vendors.

GitLab supports your digital transformation because it is secure by design, reduces manual processes, and empowers collaboration to provide a positive civilian experience.

GitLab, The One DevSecOps platform, is for software users in government agencies, enabling them to deliver secure software faster, automate software factory deployment, and empower collaboration to serve the public - securing the speed to mission.

Positioning Strategy

Competitive Alternatives

- GitHub
- Fortify
- SonarQube

Unique Attributes

- Complete SDLC with embedded security in one platform
- Shift security left to automate security scanning and compliance adherence across the SDLC
- Cloud neutral
- Everyone can contribute at every development stage

Value

- Allow developers to see, track and fix the vulnerabilities earlier in the software development lifecycle
- Security guardrails to prevent vulnerable code from making it into production
- Connects with AWS, Google Cloud, Azure, + more
- Increase code deployment (up to 200% faster)

Who Cares A Lot

- See target audience below

Messaging Framework

Target Audience

User personas

- Application Ops - Alternative Job Titles: DevOps engineer, Lead developer, Site Reliability Engineer, AppSec Engineer
- Program Managers - Alternative Job Titles: Compliance Program Manager, Audit Report Analyst, Audit Events Analyst
- Contracting Officer

Buyer personas

- DevOps Leader
- Chief Technology Officer (CTO)
- Chief Information Officer (CIO)
- Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)
- Procurement / Contracting Officer
- Application Development Director
- Admin / Finance Operations
- Compliance / Legal

Unifying Message

GitLab secures your speed to mission by addressing elements to stay ahead of threat vectors, automating the end-to-end DevSecOps experience, and empowering collaboration between teams and vendors. With development, operations, security, and compliance processes embedded within a single DevSecOps platform and aligning to the Improving the Nation's Cybersecurity Executive Order, GitLab helps you achieve a secure and successful digital transformation - without compromising your speed to mission.

Pain Point 1: How do we stay ahead of threat vectors to ensure we are securing the mission?

Solution: GitLab, secure by design, supports a proactive security strategy where vulnerabilities are discovered earlier (shift left) in the Software Delivery Lifecycle (SDLC) thus positioning you to be secure by design also. You are empowered to design a secure SDLC because we embed security and compliance within the end-to-end DevSecOps workflow, and application vulnerabilities are continuously addressed before code ships, helping you to understand and manage risk while aligning to NIST and CISA guidance. GitLab is vendor and deployment-neutral, addressing elements to stay ahead of threat vectors; such as a zero trust framework, for securing the software supply chain, automated creation of a software bill of materials (SBOM), and Infrastructure as Code security scanning, and support for security scanning in Offline or Limited Connectivity Environments.

Value Prop Pillars:

- Security scanning: Find vulnerabilities sooner in the SDLC with static application security testing (SAST), dynamic application security testing (DAST), secret detection, and license compliance verification.
- Automated unit testing, code quality, and fuzz testing: Automated capabilities can run on every code commit helping to prevent coding flaws.
- Offline environments: Run security scans when not connected to the internet addressing cloud-native attack surfaces without getting in the way of rapid development and with fewer tools to manage.
- Policy Management: Teams can create, maintain, and track every contribution to their software packages in a single repository with source code management.
- Optimized Workflows: Verifying code commits and releases can be challenging. GitLab helps protect source code from tampering and unauthorized contributions via source code management, protected branches, commit signatures, advanced code review capabilities, and merge approvals with hardened containers.
- Container Scanning: Vulnerabilities are automatically exposed and displayed in a merge

request to helping to address them faster and more efficiently.

- SBOM: Dependency scanning, embedded in GitLab, automatically generates an SBOM while identifying vulnerabilities in operating systems, containers, and packages. Vulnerabilities are triaged and remediated earlier in the process with solutions suggested to guide developers to a fix. Then they are automatically added to the dependency list (SBOM). This information is available for every commit rather than at the end of the software development lifecycle. Also, SBOM workflows allow users to secure the software supply chain and development environment plus easily identify software dependencies in one DevOps platform.
- Vulnerabilities are listed to provide clarity by including dependencies.
- Quick click issue creation drives simplified remediation workflows.
- When presented in a merge request (MR), view and triage them before the code is committed to the mainline.
- Safeguarding environments: Maintain a secure platform throughout the process with role-based permissions models, lightweight directory access protocol (LDAP), single sign-on (SSO), and multi-factor authentication (MFA) support. Policy management, audits, and zero trust continuously validate every interaction.
- Continuous Software Compliance: Significantly reduce the time to achieve Authority to Operate (ATO) with continuous automation of compliance management.
- FIPS 140-2: GitLab can be run in a FIPS-compliant manner and is FIPS 140-2 compliant.

Key Messages: Secure by design: Your SDLC is secure by design discovering vulnerabilities earlier helping you to shift left.

Pain Point 2: How do we overcome manual processes, dated policies, and aging technology...?

Pain Point 2: How do we overcome manual processes, dated policies, and aging technology to achieve automated software factory deployment?

Solution: GitLab with end-to-end DevSecOps workflows is built on a single codebase enabling software development that eliminates the digital duct tape inefficiencies so you can accelerate the delivery of critical capabilities.

A software factory that accelerates the delivery of critical capabilities with flexible, automatic business, development, operations, and security requirements and workflows in one DevSecOps platform speeding up Authority to Operate (ATO). Slow manual processes are eliminated, what once took months to produce is now developed, tested, and in a citizen's hands in days/weeks.

GitLab is cloud-neutral-connecting with AWS, Google Cloud, Azure, and beyond-so IT leaders and developers know it will work seamlessly with other investments now and in the future further enabling the digital transformation journey.

Value Prop Pillars:

- Automated Software Delivery: Shortened lead times from code to production reduces error frequency and severity and helps to deploy more frequently. This delivers more business value more often with less effort helping to accelerate the delivery of critical capabilities in one platform, speeding up ATO.
- Remote Delivery, Collaborative Workflow Management, and Observability: Agile project management, distributed version control based on Git, and automated CI/CD for an easy-to-deploy

and manage software factory.

- Artifact Generation: Users can take advantage of endless automation for artifact generation that is easily collected as a central standard source for remediation.

Key Messages: Automate software factory deployment: Deploy an easy-to-manage software factory quickly to build, test, and deliver applications

Pain Point 3: How do we encourage collaboration between teams and vendors...?

Pain Point 3: How do we encourage collaboration between teams and vendors while promoting employee retention?

Solution: GitLab supports public sector missions and enables collaboration between teams and vendors with multi-system integrations. Everyone can contribute at every development stage - Plan, Create, Verify, Secure, Package, Release, Configure, Monitor, Protect, and Manage within one DevSecOps platform. The embedded security, frequent update cycle, and agile project management provide visibility within the SDLC with end-to-end traceability dramatically accelerating the speed to mission · increasing code deployment by up to 200%. GitLab also increases user adoption and employee retention enabling organizations to do more for citizens, peacekeepers, students, and the public sector workforce.

GitLab intimately understands the evolving challenges of software development for mission success and is designed to empower government employees, developers, and vendors to build remotely or wherever they're most efficient. GitLab is a pioneer in remote work, recognizing it as an advantage that enables progress.

Value Prop Pillars:

- Agile project management: GitLab enables teams to apply Agile practices and principles to organize and manage their work, whatever their chosen methodology within one platform for the complete DevOps lifecycle.
- [Visibility level(<https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/development/permissions.html#general-permissions>)]: Set the visibility levels from Public, Internal to Private for your groups and projects.
- Low-to-high-side development is supported so agencies can work with the most talented developers across the country.

Key Messages: Empowering the mission: GitLab empowers collaboration between teams and vendors to come together and focus on the mission.

Competitive Differentiators:

Same as Unique Attributes listed above:

- Complete SDLC with Embedded security in one platform
- Shift security left by automating security scanning and compliance adherence across the SDLC
- Cloud neutral
- Everyone can contribute at every development stage

Proof Points/Customer References:

Secure by design:

- Posted on LinkedIn by a user who was part of Department of Defense - GitLab generates an SBOM automatically when you enable the GitLab Dependency Scanning in your .gitlab-ci.yml file. It's a one-liner to turn this on. It's as close to an "..." button as you can get these days.

Automate software factory deployment:

- The Paul G. Allen Center for Computer Science & Engineering gains control and flexibility to easily manage 10,000+ projects
- How Chicago's Cook County assesses economic data with transparency and version control

Empowering the mission:

- How the U.S. Army Cyber School created "Courseware as Code" with GitLab

GitLab is 100% remote and helps to foster collaborative environments. It has been recognized by numerous awards, including as a Best Workplace by Inc. Magazine and a Top Small and Medium Workplace for Millennials by Fortune.

Use Cases

Secure by Design

- Challenge: Increasing cyber-attacks and cybersecurity threats from internal and external entities
- Solution: One DevSecOps Platform, secure by design, enables you to secure your software supply chain staying ahead of threat vectors
- Benefits: Remediate vulnerabilities before pushing to production with automated scanning earlier in the SDLC (shifting left), producing well-secured software

Software Factory

- Challenge: Manual processes, dated policies, and aging technology prevent digital transformation
- Solution: One DevSecOps Platform that automates, end-to-end DevSecOps workflows, manual, and repetitive tasks in the software delivery life cycle (SDLC)
- Benefits: Deploy an easy-to-manage software factory improving velocity to build, test, and deliver applications

Low to High Development

- Challenge: Collaboration is siloed with teams working in multiple isolated, classified, or air-gapped networks
- Solution: One DevSecOps Platform with project export/import
- Benefits: Streamlined processes and tools, seamless collaboration, control and visibility

GitOps

- Challenge: Need to manage and automate infrastructure and application deployment, version control is not centralized, ops unable to iterate at pace of Dev
- Solution: One DevSecOps Platform with GitOps functionality - on-prem, cloud, cloud neutral

- Benefits: Increase agility in meeting customer demands of commercial cloud vendors capabilities (elasticity) while fostering visibility and collaboration across teams

SBOM (Software Bill of Materials)

- Challenge: Weak software supply chain leads to security breaches and invisible security threats
- Solution: One DevSecOps Platform with security embedded - pre-build dependency scanning for SBOM generation, vulnerability workflows, and speedy resolutions
- Benefits: Insights into dependencies across transient structures, teams can expedite remediation activities with SBOM vulnerabilities displayed in the UI

ATO (Authority to Operate)

- Challenge: The ATO process at the end of the SDLC adds unplanned and unscheduled work to delivery timelines
- Solution: One DevSecOps Platform that automates compliance management to significantly reduce time to achieve ATO
- Benefits: Accelerate the delivery of critical capabilities with flexible, automatic business, development, operations, and security workflows in one platform

SWOTT Analysis

Strengths

- Empowers users to be collaborative which brings efficiency
- Multiple functionalities align to NIST guidelines from Executive Order
- Shift Left - vulnerabilities are discovered earlier in the SDLC with several security scanning processes - DAST, SAST, fuzz testing, secret detection, and more
- Forrester recognition as a Leader for the Forrester CI Tools Wave
- Hardened Container story/DoD software factory relationships
- Low-to-high side DevOps (Cross-Domain DevOps)
- Single application for entire DevOps lifecycle
- Leader in CI & Cloud Native CI/Leading SCM/Optimized for k8s
- Built-in continuous and automated security & compliance
- Flexible hosting options/Software can be deployed anywhere
- End-to-end insight and visibility
- Open source
- Enables rapid innovation
- Provides collaborative and transparent CX

Weaknesses

- Not FedRAMP authorized
- Use cases where third party integration is needed to work with Kubernetes
- More awareness is needed for the EO/NIST story
- Lacking messaging and marketing assets for the different verticals within the Public Sector, i.e. SLED, Civilian, Intelligence, DOD

Opportunities

- Federal government increased the 2022 budget by 11% to \$10.9 billion for civilian cybersecurity activities
- Authorizations to grow in the sector:
 - Will be FIPS 140-2 in FY2023
 - Will be FedRAMP authorized
- Continue to tell the story how GitLab aligns to NIST/EO - drumbeat the market
- Built-in container registry and Kubernetes integration for easy containerization and cloud native development
- Enablement of Digital Transformation
- Continuing cloud modernization/Cloud Native and 100% cloud agnostic

Threats

- Strong Microsoft environments tend to get free tools (GitHub) when they purchase the Cloud + Office
- Strong preference is given to approved, incumbent solutions, i.e. Fortify and SonarQube
- Microsoft/Google announced products/solution for NIST/EO
- Lack of GitLab ability to maneuver fast enough to respond/competitors with FedRAMP authorization and EO/NIST alignment

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/qbr.md

Strategic QBR Support

At GitLab, we conduct quarterly business reviews to understand and learn from our interactions with customers. In Product and Solution Marketing, we support the QBR process and actively listen to both capture key learnings and to identify future actions that we can take to improve our messaging, positioning, and collateral to help our sales team help customers.

Overview

1. We attend and participate in each QBR.
2. In the QBR, we capture action items
 - first in a single SM Action Item google doc, and
 - then we create an issue to track the action item using the SM Request Process <link>

Details - as a QBR attendee

1. Open the QBR action tracking document
1. Scroll to the QBR meeting that you are supporting (the document should be preloaded with the agenda and key links)
 1. If needed, add links to the QBR Detailed Notes Document (where live notes are captured), and link to the Slides Folder, and individual rep Slides
1. Listen for specific strategic marketing requests or action items. Capture the action item

in the google doc in as much detail as you can. Ask questions and get clarification - that's why you're in the QBR

1. Click on the Create Product and Solution Marketing QBR Action Issue link
1. Update the title of the issue using the Quick Action 'title' on line 2.
1. Write the issue in detail about what, who and why they need support. (Avoid ambiguous, vague, and non-actionable issues)
1. After you submit the issue. Copy the issue link and add it to the Action Item Document.

QBR Set up

1. Work with the Sales Ops / Sales Enablement team to determine the QBR schedule. When, where, and who is speaking. Get links to the folder where the QBR slides will be stored.
1. Create an EPIC at the Marketing Group level to track QBR action items.
1. Set up the Action Item Document
 1. Make a copy of the Product and Solution Marketing QBR Action Item template, which is stored in this folder.
 1. Name Action Document "FYXX -QN - QBR Product and Solution Marketing Action Item" - where the FY and Quarter are for the upcoming quarter.
 1. Move the Action Document to the correct FY folder.
 1. Open the Action Document for editing and:
 1. Update the Title "FYNN-QN" with the current FY and Quarter
 1. At the bottom of Page 1 - Update the LINKs to the QBR Master Schedule, the QBR Slide Folder (top level), and the Epic that will be used to track QBR items

For EACH QBR Meeting:

1. Create a copy Page 2 (The section for each QBR action items) for EACH QBR Meeting.
1. Update the Header "Date-Region" to be the specific date and Region.
1. Add the link to the QBR Notes Document (If it exists yet)
1. Add the link to the QBR Slides folder for THIS SPECIFIC QBR.
1. From the QBR Agenda, update the Agenda Outline with the reps names in the order they are presenting.
 1. IF their slides are loaded in the folder, Update their Name to include a link to their specific slide deck.
1. Update the QBR-Action-Item issue template in the Product Marketing Project
 1. Change the LINK to the Action Items Doc to point to the document you just created
 1. Change the LINK to the Epic to point to this quarter's QBR EPIC
 1. Change the LABEL quick action to match the QBR FY/Quarter

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/release-updates.md

Current updates

Internal: Contribute 2021

For GitLab team members only, Product leadership presented a Product Keynote 2021-11-16 at Contribute 2021, with a recording of the video available in EdCast.

the deck presented, also internal:

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/14moh7hjCMO02ABavsrBXR5lnzdeZd9F67Hd8FkoSy6
U/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=3000" frameborder="0" width="960" height="569"
allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true" webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
</figure>
```

14.1.14.4 Sales enablement

See also: upcoming sessions in the Sales Enablement handbook. The Q3 FY22 Product Update was 2021-11-04, and embedded below are internal versions of the video and deck presented. Here are links to the external versions of: the video recording and the deck presented.

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/z6hFnUtm2Gk"
frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture"
allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>
```

and deck (internal):

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1WECT2c2d7FmfjR0woYhU-
PY0FjFl8a54YDbQE3yinA/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=3000" frameborder="0" width="960"
height="569" allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true"
webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
</figure>
```

Covering these releases:

- 2021-10-22 GitLab 14.4 released with Scheduled DAST scans and Integrated error tracking
- 2021-09-22 GitLab 14.3 releases Project Security Policies & Next Gen SAST
- 2021-08-22 GitLab 14.2 released with the Build Cloud for macOS beta and Markdown preview
- 2021-07-22 GitLab 14.1 released with Helm Chart Registry and Escalation Policies

Commit Virtual 2021: Product sessions

Product Keynote: Innovating Together on the Next Generation of DevOps, (deck, GitLab-internal), 2021-08-04

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/jNE-lvpDeoc"
frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture"
allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>
```

The Next Iteration of DevOps, GitLab CEO Keynote with Sid Sijbrandij, 2021-08-03

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
```

<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/Wx8tDVSeidk" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

What the ML is up with DevOps and AI? A ModelOps Overview, 2021-08-04

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/7mUgGFgab4E" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

Recent releases

For a list of all release posts including patch releases, see this blog category, 'releases'.

Find future releases, with their most important features flagged, on Product's upcoming releases page. You can also see upcoming features for paid product tiers, listed by tier.

Information about the release currently running on GitLab SaaS is at the GitLab SaaS release page.

Past updates

13.8-14.0, GitLab 14 Sales enablement

The Q2 FY22 Product Update was 2021-07-08:

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/DC-Cdd-RNY" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

We focused on GitLab 14 but covered all versions since SKO, with this presentation:

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1CqCVool3S6rrnSOoQ6c0YL2vXxfnBAdMsAx7OatXL4/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=3000" frameborder="0" width="960" height="569" allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true" webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
</figure>

Covering these releases:

- 2021-06-22 GitLab 14.0 released with a celebration of GitLab 14
- 2021-05-22 GitLab 13.12 released with On-Demand DAST and Deployment Frequency Chart
- 2021-04-22 GitLab 13.11 released with Kubernetes Agent and Pipeline Compliance
- 2021-03-22 GitLab 13.10 released with Admin Enhancements and Vulnerability Management
- 2021-02-22 GitLab 13.9 released with a Security Alert Dashboard and Maintenance Mode

- 2021-01-22 GitLab 13.8 released with a Pipeline Editor and DORA metrics

13.4·13.7 SKO Product Keynote

The SKO Product Keynote video and the deck presented in 2021-02 are GitLab-internal only.

There was a focus on these releases, along with more from fiscal 21 and a look ahead:

- 2020-12-22 GitLab 13.7 released with merge request reviewers and automatic rollback upon failure
- 2020-11-22 GitLab 13.6 released with Auto Deploy to EC2 and Usage Trends Dashboard
- 2020-10-22 GitLab 13.5 released with Mobile App Sec, Group Wikis, and more!
- 2020-09-22 GitLab 13.4 released with Vault for CI variables and Kubernetes Agent

13.0·13.3 Sales enablement

The Q3 FY21 Product Release Update was 2020-08-20:

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/Wldab4cx9OE" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

The content was updated with more information on use of the GitLab Value Framework, including in this presentation:

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1GHePaoupd-4CMbwY2qyySba908ukTUHLgGyyV9IDZyY/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=3000" frameborder="0" width="960" height="569" allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true" webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
</figure>

Covering these releases:

- 2020-08-22 GitLab 13.3 released with coverage-guided fuzz testing and a build matrix for CI/CD
- 2020-07-22 GitLab 13.2 released with Planning Iterations and Load Performance Testing
- 2020-06-22 GitLab 13.1 released with Alert Management and Code Quality Enhancements
- 2020-05-22 GitLab 13.0 released with Gitaly Clusters, Epic Hierarchy on Roadmaps, and Auto Deploy to ECS

12.9·13.0 Sales enablement

The Q2 FY21 Product Release Update was 2020-06-04:

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="1027" height="642" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/36-G7teGhwY" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

With this presentation:

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</figure>

Covering these releases:

- 2020-05-22 GitLab 13.0 released with Gitaly Clusters, Epic Hierarchy on Roadmaps, and Auto Deploy to ECS
- 2020-04-22 GitLab 12.10 released with Requirements Management and Autoscaling CI on AWS Fargate
- 2020-03-22 GitLab 12.9 released with Vault App, Code Quality Reports and Group Deploy Tokens

13.0 Launch

GitLab 13.0 was launched on 2020-05-22 with this release blog post. The major release launch featured this video of Scott Williamson, then CPO, sharing 13.0 highlights and insight into key drivers of our product strategy:

<figure class="videocontainer">
<iframe width="1198" height="674" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/dStlhTP1ckg" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture" allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>

Version 12 Year in Review

Leading into the GitLab 13.0 launch, this blog post, including a video and slide deck reviewed versions 12.0-12.10.

Major product themes are more apparent over this year of GitLab versions than they generally are in one month or quarter. For GitLab 12.x, these include "treating developers, security, and operations alike as first-class citizens in DevOps" and expanding the definition of DevOps and its practitioners, for example by building in Design Management and Requirements Management.

12.3-12.8 Sales enablement

This product release update covered 12.3-12.8 for FY21 Q1 and FY20 Q4, and was delivered 2020-02-27:

<figure class="videocontainer">
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</figure>

With this presentation:

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rMmyUat1wzemz1mU3OdiJ3W2fb6kg/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=3000" frameborder="0"
width="960" height="569" allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true"
webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
</figure>
```

And in these meeting notes, covering these six releases:

- 2020-02-22 GitLab 12.8 released with Log Explorer, NuGet, and Compliance
- 2020-01-22 GitLab 12.7 released with Parent-Child Pipelines and Windows Shared Runners Beta
- 2019-12-22 GitLab 12.6 released with Security Scorecard and Release Evidence
- 2019-11-22 GitLab 12.5 released with EKS Cluster Creation & Environments Dashboard
- 2019-10-22 GitLab 12.4 released with improved Merge Request Dependencies and Audit API
- 2019-09-22 GitLab 12.3 released with Web Application Firewall and Productivity Analytics

12.0·12.2 Sales enablement

Our first-ever quarterly, sales-focused product release update covered 12.0·12.2 for FY20 Q3 in 2019-08. This recording on GitLab Unfiltered shares highlights and analysis from the shared notes document.

In addition to product highlights, the session called out new business value and selling opportunities in Ultimate or Premium, along with what to expect in GitLab 12.3·12.5.

Releases covered:

- 2019-08-22 GitLab 12.2 released with Directed Acyclic Graphs for Pipelines and Design Management
- 2019-07-22 GitLab 12.1 released with Parallel Merge Trains and Merge Requests for Confidential Issues
- 2019-06-22 GitLab 12.0 released with Visual Reviews and Dependency List

12.0 Launch

The GitLab 12.0 launch included a livestreamed program: 11.0 to 12.0: How we got to DevSecOps in a single application, and in that, an Ask Me Anything featuring GitLab CEO Sid Sijbrandij.

> GitLab 12.0 marks a key step in our journey to create an inclusive approach to DevSecOps, empowering 'everyone to contribute'.

>

> We believe everyone can contribute, and we've enabled cross-team collaboration, faster delivery of great code, and bringing together Dev, Ops, and Security.

Read more in the 12.0 release blog post: GitLab 12.0 released with Visual Reviews and Dependency List.

Version 11 Year in Review

GitLab's Version 11 year in review provided an overview of what we released, 11.0 to 12.0 as we moved into DevSecOps:

```
<figure class="videocontainer">
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frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture"
allowfullscreen></iframe>
</figure>
```

11.0 Launch

The theme of our 11.0 launch was Auto DevOps (as it had been for 10.0):

> Beyond making it easy to host and collaborate on public and private repositories, GitLab also simplifies the rest of the process by offering the whole delivery toolchain, built in. And now, it's not only built in, it's automated. Simply commit your code and Auto DevOps can do the rest. Auto DevOps is a pre-built, fully featured CI/CD pipeline that automates the entire delivery process.

Read more in the 11.0 release blog post: [GitLab 11.0 released with Auto DevOps and License Management](#).

10.0 Launch

The theme of our 10.0 launch was Auto DevOps:

> From the formulation of an idea to executing and monitoring it in production, DevOps establishes a culture and environment where developing, testing, and releasing software can happen quickly, frequently, and more reliably.

>

> GitLab 10.0 delivers a hands-free DevOps environment with the introduction of Auto DevOps, allowing your team to easily configure and adopt modern development practices in your workflow.

Read more in the 10.0 release blog post: [GitLab 10.0 released with Auto DevOps and Group Issue Boards](#).

Planned updates

Product Marketing delivers quarterly product release update Sales enablement sessions. These are aligned with the product year, beginning with annual, major releases like 14.0 on 2021-06-22, which dovetailed with the GitLab 14 product launch. Major releases and launches may include looks back and forward, such as a "year in review" blog post.

Monthly release blog posts continue to announce monthly releases with Product Marketing support, though the introductions to release posts are now brief. Customer value-add is now described in the content blocks for headline and key features, in the body of each release post.

Version 14 enablements will include a GitLab 14 internal session for the Field, public Commit Virtual 2021 keynotes and talks that are product-related, a 14.1-14.4 quarterly session, and the FY23 SKO product keynote. We may also have an FY23Q2 session leading into the launch of GitLab 15.

GitLab's annual, major release may move a month forward or back as needed. We moved Version 13 forward one month, leaving Version 12's last release as 12.10 rather than 12.11, to track our product year quarters with those of our fiscal year. We later added version 13.12 to the product year, shipped on 2021-05-22 and moving 14.0 back to 2021-06-22.

Purpose

Product Marketing delivers quarterly and annual, sales-centric updates of:

- How recent product releases enhance GitLab's value proposition for solving customers' business problems
- How these releases enhance the value of Premium and Ultimate
- What is coming in the next quarter

This page merges release resources from Product and Marketing with related Sales Enablement pages, videos, and presentations. A "handbook-first" approach makes resources more findable and usable by Sales or anyone interested, and provides a stronger foundation for learning.

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/reseller-kit.md

Getting Started

The information contained in this section will provide you with solid understanding of who is GitLab, what do we do and where are we going in the future.

- GitLab narrative and high-level deck
- GitLab elevator pitch
- GitLab solutions
- GitLab pricing
 - Value of selling GitLab Ultimate
- GitLab product vision/roadmap
- GitLab personas
- GitLab competitive analysis
- Customer success stories

Join GitLab's Slack Reseller channel by emailing vgoetz@gitlab.com to keep current on new content assets, upcoming sales and technical training sessions and more.

Training & Enablement

- GitLab Product training - Providing a subset of on-demand content suggested based on role and skill level. Each track links to the specific on-demand training area GitLab recommends.

- GitLab sales enablement list
- Future GitLab sales enablement

Security specific information

- GitLab Secure capabilities enablement
- GitLab Secure demo
- GitLab Security dashboard enablement

Marketing Resources

- GitLab boilerplate web content
- GitLab official logo, guidelines and other artwork - scroll all the way down to the Images & Logos section
- Reseller marketing issue board (coming soon)

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Can one organization implement Free, Premium and Ultimate at the same time?
1. What is the difference in GitLab Ultimate self-managed and SaaS?

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/tiers.md

Overview

Tier	Delivery	Deployment Type	License
Fee			
-----	-----	-----	
-----	-----		
Free	Self-Managed and SaaS	Self-Managed and GitLab.com	open source
unpaid			
Premium	Self-Managed and SaaS	Self-Managed and GitLab.com	source-
available	paid		
Ultimate	Self-Managed and SaaS	Self-Managed, Dedicated, and GitLab.com	source-
available	paid		

Definitions

1. Tier: a GitLab offering that provides a set of features at a particular price point.
1. Users: anyone who uses GitLab regardless of tier.
1. Customers: users on a paid tier.
1. Plans: the paid tiers only.
1. License: open source vs. source-available, for example moving a feature from a source-available tier to an open-source tier.
1. Distribution: self-managed CE vs. EE, for example you can have a EE distribution but in the Free tier.
1. Version: the release of GitLab, for example asking what version a user is on.
1. Product Category: An internal field that identifies the primary product sold on an

opportunity.

Types of Users

1. Free User - anyone who uses GitLab free tier and does not pay for additional compute minutes or storage (but is eligible to beyond what is included in the free tier).
1. Trial User - anyone who is currently in trial on one of the paid tiers.
1. Consumption User - anyone who uses GitLab free tier and pays by consumption for additional compute minutes or storage beyond what is included in the free tier.
1. Licensed User - anyone who is on a source-available license
 1. Ultimate User - a licensed user on Ultimate
 1. Premium User - a licensed user on Premium
 1. Starter User - a licensed user on Starter (No longer available, but some users are finishing out previously purchased licenses.)
1. Program User - anyone who is on Premium or Ultimate tier through programs such as GitLab for Startups, GitLab for Education or GitLab for Open Source

Delivery

In general each of the self-managed tiers match the features in the GitLab SaaS tiers. They have different names for two reasons:

1. There is not complete feature parity between self-managed and GitLab SaaS plans. For example, GitLab self-managed Premium, and Ultimate include LDAP Group Sync but GitLab SaaS Premium and Ultimate do not.
1. We want to know if a user is using self-managed or GitLab SaaS based on just the tier name to prevent internal and external confusion.

When we need to specify which tier includes a particular feature using only one word (for example on our issue tracker), we reference the self-managed tiers by default because they tend to contain a superset of the GitLab SaaS tier features.

Where we can, we highlight both the self-managed and the GitLab SaaS tiers (like in a release post).

Add on Services

Add on services extend the functionality of the Tier and do not represent a new Tier. These add on services can include, but are not limited to, adding Storage, Compute Minutes, Agile Planning, and AI features to the existing tier the subscription is on. Add-ons can be made available on one, multiple, or all tiers depending upon the tier availability of the add on service being provided.

Libre, gratis, and free

When discussing their work, open source communities typically use the words "gratis" and "libre" instead of the word "free" to describe the nature of the software they create. This is because the English word "free" is an ambiguous word that can have several meanings: "no cost" ("free as in beer"), "with few or no restrictions" ("free as in speech"), or both. Open source communities therefore prefer to use the unambiguous term "gratis" when referring to "no cost" software and the term "libre" when refer to software "with few or no restrictions." Open source

software is "libre" in that anyone is "free" to inspect, modify, and redistribute it. But open source software may or may not be "gratis."

Features that are part of GitLab's Free tier refer to open source software that is both gratis and libre-free as in speech and as in beer. For more detail on this distinction, see Wikipedia.

GitLab SaaS

We call the multi-tenant GitLab SaaS, GitLab.com (with the G and L capitalized) since it is unambiguous and common.

We don't call it GitLab Cloud since most self-managed instances of GitLab are hosted in the cloud as well, and if we introduce single tenant instances it will be even more confusing.

GitLab Dedicated offers a new way to use our enterprise DevSecOps platform as a single-tenant SaaS offering. This offering provides all of the benefits of an enterprise DevSecOps platform, with an added focus on data residency, isolation, and private networking to meet compliance needs.

Personal vs group subscriptions

GitLab SaaS subscriptions are added to either a personal namespace or a group namespace. Personal subscriptions apply to a single user while Group subscriptions apply to all users in the Group.

History of CE and EE distributions

Historically, GitLab was provided as two different software distributions, each with their own separate source code repository and documentation: Community Edition (CE) and Enterprise Edition (EE). As of GitLab version 12.3, released on 2020-09-22, GitLab moved to a single code base.

The "CE" and "EE" names referred to the actual software packages that were downloaded and installed. Today, the single distribution is referred to as the "Official Linux package".

For a period of time, GitLab pricing tiers also used "CE" and "EE". When the free, self-managed tier was changed from "CE" to "Free", it led to this dynamic:

Free users could use either one of two distributions: Community Edition (CE) and Enterprise Edition (EE). Enterprise Edition can be downloaded, installed, and run without a commercial subscription. In this case it runs using the open source license and only has access to the open source features. In effect, EE without a subscription, and CE, have the exact same functionality.

Premium, and Ultimate users could only use Enterprise Edition.

If a Free user was running CE and wanted to upgrade to a paid tier, they had to re-install and migrate to EE. The advantage of using EE as a Free user is that it is much easier to upgrade to a commercial subscription later on. All that's needed is to install a license key to access more features vs needing to re-install a different distribution. Today, GitLab's single distribution maintains these advantages.

See the Tier Messaging section for how to talk about GitLab, distributions, versions, tiers, pricing, and licenses.

How we used the terms CE and EE

Community Edition (CE) and Enterprise Edition (EE) refer to software distributions of GitLab. We used to encourage customers to use the EE distribution since it provided the least painful upgrade path if/when users discovered they needed commercial features. If you aren't talking specifically about the distribution packages, then don't use these terms, you are probably using them incorrectly.

Don't use CE/EE to refer to non-paid/paid users

Users can be on the EE distribution for free. Distribution doesn't imply if a user is a customer or not.

1. Say "users" when you mean all users - paid and unpaid.
1. Say "customers" when you mean paid users.
1. Say "Free users" when you mean unpaid users.

- Incorrect: "Let's run a marketing campaign to encourage CE users to upgrade to a paid tier."
- Correct: "Let's run a marketing campaign to encourage Free users to upgrade to a paid tier."

Don't use CE/EE to refer to tiers

GitLab has 3 tiers: Free, Premium, and Ultimate. Distribution doesn't imply which tier a user is on.

1. Say the "Free" when you mean the \$0 tier.
1. Say "Open source" when you mean features in the \$0 tier.
1. Say "Premium" or "Ultimate" to refer to those tiers.
1. Optionally, say "GitLab Free," "GitLab Premium," or "GitLab Ultimate" when you want to refer to a pricing tier.
1. Say "commercial tier" when you mean any paid tier.

- Incorrect: "Let's move this feature to CE."
- Correct: "Let's open source this feature."
- Correct: "Let's move this feature from Ultimate to Free."

NOTE: Talking about "open sourcing a feature" is highly preferred to saying we want to "move a feature to Free." Open source calls attention to the fact that not only is the feature available for \$0 now, it's also available for open community contribution in our MIT licensed codebase. "Free" only calls attention to the \$0 price without highlighting our open source community.

GitLab trials

We offer a free trial for self-managed GitLab as well as a free trial for GitLab.com Ultimate.

Why offer a free trial when we already have free tiers?

The trial allows users to have access to all of the features of GitLab Ultimate. Users on the Free plans (self-managed and SaaS) plans get access to a limited set of features for an unlimited amount of time. Trial users get access to a full set of features for a limited amount of time (30-days).

License type	Features	Time Period
Free	Limited (Open source features only)	unlimited
Trial	Unlimited (access to all Ultimate features)	limited (30 days)

Open-source vs. source-available

GitLab is an open-core product that contains both open-source and source-available code. The source-available code is proprietary (so not open-source) but you can view the source code. Please don't use CE, EE, or Free to refer to the type of license since:

1. While most open source code is in GitLab CE, some code in EE is additional open source code since all our javascript code is MIT licensed.
1. The majority of the code in EE is open source.
1. We might ship source-available code in Free that is free as in beer but not as in freedom (open source).

Tier Messaging

When talking to customers, always use language that they are familiar with. They will likely not be familiar with terms we use internally as a company, it is important to use the customer's language when you are talking to the customer to maximize understanding.

Themes Hierarchy

The themes hierarchy is designed to communicate the value of GitLab paid features to customers.

1. Value Drivers: Themes roll into customer value drivers. Value drivers describe what organizations are likely proactively looking for or needing and are top-of-mind customer topics that exist even if GitLab doesn't. Value drivers may cause buyers to re-allocate discretionary funds, and they support a value-based customer conversation. Organizations adopt and implement GitLab for the following value drivers:

Value drivers are also highlighted within tiers.

1. Themes: Themes refer to sets of paid features. They highlight the benefits of features through grouping related paid features together, so customers can focus on a short-list of benefits rather than a long list of 80+ paid features. Themes can be found on GitLab's pricing page. Each tier has about five themes. For example, better code reviews, compliance, or portfolio management. When clicking on a theme on the pricing page, users will find a list of paid features that relate directly to a specific theme. For example, better code reviews is a theme that encompasses the following paid features: code and productivity analytics, efficient merge request reviews, code quality reports, merge trains, and multiple approvers.

1. Paid Features: Paid features are small, discrete functionalities that are not included in GitLab's free tier. Paid features have historically been grouped into tiers, but this does little to call out key feature themes that differentiate one tier from the next and help customers to make sense of the key benefits derived from a long list of paid features. Paid features should be grouped into themes.

Tiers and pricing messaging

1. Do always present Ultimate as the product. Every customer and prospect would benefit greatly from the Ultimate product and it's the correct frame of reference to explain our complete vision.

1. Don't introduce lower tiers unnecessarily. We are consultative sellers with a high-value product. If a customer asks about pricing, the answer is "We have end-to-end DevOps in a single application ranging from our free offering up to Ultimate at \$1,188 per user per year." Only go into detail on the lower tiers when appropriate based on your assessment of the customer's needs and progression in the product. Focus on the value sale as long as possible and only discuss tiers once there is a clear path forward to purchase.

Use of "GitLab" by itself

1. Don't use the word "GitLab" alone unless you are referring to the company or an attribute that applies to both GitLab Self-managed and GitLab SaaS. If talking about an attribute that only applies to one delivery method but not the other, then specify (e.g. "GitLab SaaS does X" or "GitLab Self-managed does X").

1. Do specify GitLab Self-managed or GitLab SaaS when you are referencing something that is unique to that delivery method (e.g. a security bug that only affects GitLab SaaS).

1. Do use the word GitLab alone to refer to Ultimate. "GitLab does X" means, "GitLab Ultimate does X".

1. Don't use GitLab by itself when you really mean a specific, e.g. specify GitLab Free if you are referring to the free self-managed tier.

Using open source, commercial, and source-available

Distinguish our \$0 tiers from our paid tiers, by talking about our "open source" offerings and our "commercial" offerings.

For example, "I see that today you are using GitLab Free, I'd love to set up a call to discuss the value your business can get by upgrading from our open source offering to a commercial tier." (You could write the same sentence and use "paid" instead of "commercial" but that puts the focus on what they have to do, i.e. pay, instead of what they get, i.e. business-grade, commercial software.)

Use the terms "open source" and "source-available" to talk about our different license models.

Don't use CE and EE to refer to a specific code. MIT Licensed (code is open source) and Proprietary (code is source-available) refer to code. Both CE and EE distributions include MIT licensing.

Using the word Enterprise

1. Do use "enterprise" to describe a market segment. e.g. good phrases to use are: "GitLab provides DevOps for the enterprise", "GitLab is enterprise-ready", "GitLab has many enterprise customers", and "GitLab provides enterprise software for the entire DevOps lifecycle."

1. Don't use "enterprise" as a modifier for tiers such as Enterprise Starter, Enterprise Premium, or Enterprise Ultimate.

1. Don't use the terms Enterprise Edition Starter, Enterprise Edition Premium, Enterprise Edition Ultimate, EES, EEP, or EEU. These have all been deprecated.

GitLab FOSS

GitLab FOSS is neither a tier, nor a distribution. It is a repository.

SECTION: marketing/brand-and-product-marketing/product-and-solution-marketing/analyst-relations/_index.md

Industry Analyst Relations at GitLab

Industry Analyst Relations (IAR) is generally considered to be a corporate strategy, communications and marketing activity, but at GitLab, because of our mission that everyone can contribute, we view the industry analyst community as participants as well. The primary owner/DRI of Industry Analyst Relations (including but not limited to relationships, communication, coordination, research participation, and contractual arrangements with industry analysts and their respective firms) at GitLab is Portfolio Marketing. This is in order to provide the most accurate, consistent, and comprehensive perspective on GitLab to industry analysts and to enable receiving the same from industry analysts.

If you would like to engage the analysts (e.g. research a topic, ask questions of an analyst, request analyst reports, brief an analyst) please click [here](#) for the research request form.

How we interact with the analyst community

Examples of how we engage with analysts include:

- Briefings to update analysts on our product, our company, and our future direction
- Inquiries where analysts answer specific questions we have about product strategy, messaging, competitive positioning
- Advisory days for a deeper dive into the products, markets, and strategies
- Responding to analyst RFIs in support of comparative analyst research such as Forrester Waves, Gartner Magic Quadrants, and IDC MarketScapes
- Collaborating on market research products, surveys, sales enablement tools, etc.
- Providing an analyst newsletter to update analysts on what GitLab is doing between briefings
- Promoting analyst reports that feature GitLab to help enhance or clarify our story for customers, prospects, and partners
- Inviting analysts to participate in webinars, speaking engagements, media engagement, and other events where an analyst presence would be beneficial

How we on-board a new analyst to the GitLab Analyst Relations community

- Open an issue in the Product Marketing project using the Analyst On-boarding template that details:

- what they cover
- alignment with internal use cases and technology areas
- plan for engagement
- Set them up in ARInsights, the third party analyst-tracking software we use
- Add them to the appropriate analyst newsletter distribution list
- Add them to the appropriate use case profile(s)

How we off-board an analyst from the GitLab Analyst Relations community

- Open an issue in the Product Marketing project using the Analyst Off-boarding template that details:

- Identify their reason for off-boarding, including departure or change or coverage
- Identify who is their short-term/long-term replacement
- Remove them from ARInsights distribution lists
- Remove them from the appropriate use case profile(s)
- Notify the product management and product marketing teams

How We Conduct Industry Analyst Briefings

How We Conduct Industry Analyst Briefings

How We Conduct Industry Analyst Inquiries

How We Conduct Industry Analyst Inquiries

How we incorporate Use Cases into our industry analyst interactions

- An initial round of inquiries to explore and get input into market requirements, target personas, etc. for a given use case
- Ongoing briefings to provide updates on progress made within the scope of a given use case
- Subsequent inquiry calls to revisit market requirements, competitive positioning, etc. as updated to meet evolving market conditions

Responding to requests to participate in industry analyst comparison research

- GitLab evaluates participation in industry analyst comparative research to which we are invited based in large part on how well we meet the qualification criteria and how we are likely to score for strategy/vision. When participating, we are committed to providing our best possible answers for the questionnaires.
- The teams responsible for answering the questionnaire will make this a priority. We will:
 - Present every feature in the best possible light so we have the most defensible chance at high scores.
 - Provide whatever evidence we can that illustrates our current and future capability to address the market needs identified by the analysts.
 - When responding to the analyst request, challenge ourselves to find a way to honestly, unhesitatingly say "yes" and paint the product in the best light possible. We carefully work to understand specific feature and capability descriptions that often make up inclusion, exclusion

and even evaluation criteria. If, at first glance we think we may not or do not support a specific feature or capability as described, we will take a deeper, second look at the requirement and look to see if there is a way that our existing features solve the problem at hand.

- Present our overall solution within the context of the entirety of a specific, defined market, meaning these exercises are bake-offs; we are being evaluated in comparison to everyone else rather than in comparison to an ideal world. We should take into account the competitive landscape as we craft our position and support it.

- Our demo should be viewed as a further proof point of our solution and a way to demonstrate things we might not be able to illustrate or otherwise communicate the way we'd like to in the questionnaire response.

Process for responding to industry analyst comparison research

Before the questionnaire arrives

- GitLab AR is aware of what industry analyst research comparing vendors and/or their products (e.g. Magic Quadrants (MQs), Waves, etc.) we may be asked to participate in, particularly if we have done so before. AR should be checking with Forrester/Gartner to see if

- A MQ or Wave or similar comparative research is likely to be repeated

- The likely time frame for that comparative research (MQ, Wave, etc.) to begin

- Once the timeline is determined, 30-45 days in advance AR will

- Set up an inquiry with the lead analyst(s) to discuss customer inquiries they have received on this topic over the last year and gain insight on where they think the market is at currently

- Set up a short (30 minute) demo on the relevant part of GitLab to have them aware of our present position

- GitLab usually receives notice 1-2 weeks in advance that a Wave or MQ is forthcoming, in which they can participate.

- With Forrester, the process may begin with a Now Tech report. With Gartner